

A Reconstruction of the Earliest Sayings Gospel

A reconstruction of the earliest recoverable sayings gospel

Paper proof v0.4. The clean text remains frozen; this pass changes only layout, orientation pages, indexes, and bibliography apparatus.

The original EUAGELIA contribution is intended as a commons; external sources retain their own legal status.

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Page numbers may still change during final typesetting; this contents page fixes the order of sections without pretending to final pagination.

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Clean Reconstructed Text

1 Whoever finds the interpretation of these words will not taste death.

2 Let the one who seeks not stop seeking until they find. When they find, they will be disturbed; when disturbed, they will be amazed; and they will reign.

3 Do not seek the kingdom as a place in heaven or in the sea: the kingdom is within you and outside you. When you know yourselves, you will be known, and you will know that you are children of the living Father. If you do not know yourselves, you are in poverty, and you are poverty.

4 Many who are first will become last, and the last first. An old person will not hesitate to ask a seven-day-old child about the place of life, and that person will live; they will become one.

5 Nothing is hidden that will not become manifest. Know what is before your face, and what is hidden from you will be revealed to you.

6 Do not lie, and do not do what you hate.

9 A sower went out to sow. Some seed fell on the road, some on rock, some among thorns, and some on good soil; only the good soil bore fruit.

10 I cast fire upon the world.

16 I came not to bring peace, but division; a house will be divided.

20 The kingdom is like a mustard seed: it is small, but it grows and gives shelter to the birds of heaven.

22 Little children are like those who enter the kingdom.

25 Love your brother as your own soul; guard him as the apple of your eye.

26 You see the speck in your brother's eye, but you do not see the beam in your own eye. When you remove the beam from your own eye, then you will see clearly how to remove the speck from your brother's eye.

31 A prophet is not accepted in his own place. And a physician does not heal those who know him.

32 A city built and fortified on a high mountain cannot fall and cannot be hidden.

33 What you hear in your ear, proclaim from the rooftops. No one lights a lamp to put it under a measure or in a hidden place; it is put on a lampstand so that all may see the light.

34 If a blind person leads a blind person, both will fall into a pit.

35 No one can enter a strong man's house and take his possessions unless he first binds his hands; then he will plunder his house.

36 Do not be anxious from morning until evening and from evening until morning about what you will wear.

39 The scribes and Pharisees have taken the keys of knowledge: they did not enter, and they did not allow those who wished to enter. Be wise as serpents and pure as doves.

41 Whoever has will be given more; whoever does not have will lose even the little that they have.

45 Grapes are not gathered from thorns, nor figs from thistles.

46 Among those born of women none is greater than John; yet the least in the kingdom is greater than he.

47 A servant cannot serve two masters: he will honor one and despise the other.

54 Blessed are the poor, for the kingdom of heaven belongs to you.

63 A rich man had many possessions. He planned to sow, reap, plant, and fill his storehouses so that he would lack nothing. That night he died.

72 A man said to him, "Tell my brothers to divide my father's property with me." He said to him, "Man, who made me a divider?" And turning to his disciples, he said, "Am I a divider?"

73 The harvest is great, but the workers are few. Ask the Lord to send workers into the harvest.

86 Foxes have holes, birds have nests, but the Son of Man has nowhere to lay his head.

89 Why do you clean the outside of the cup? Do you not understand that the one who made the inside also made the outside?

91 You know how to read the face of heaven and earth, but you do not recognize this time.

95 If you have money, do not lend at interest; give to the one from whom you do not expect to receive it back.

96 The kingdom is like a woman who took a little leaven and hid it in dough.

99 Those who do the Father's will are my brothers and my mother.

100 Give Caesar what belongs to Caesar, and God what belongs to God.

103 Blessed is the one who knows when the thief is coming and keeps watch before he comes.

107 A shepherd had one hundred sheep. One of them went astray; he left the ninety-nine and searched for it until he found it.

How To Read This Edition

The logion numbers follow the conventional numbering of the Gospel of Thomas. Where only a core or subunit is printed in the clean reconstruction, the paper book keeps the familiar logion number for lookup, while the appendix explains the partial-inclusion decision.

Witness labels: NHC II,2 is the Coptic manuscript witness; P.Oxy. 1, P.Oxy. 654, and P.Oxy. 655 are Greek papyrus witnesses; Greek retroversion, hypothetical is a modern controlled reconstruction of a plausible Greek form, not an extant manuscript witness.

Appendix And Indexes

Included Logia

Logion	Status	Greek	Subject
1	in clean text	P.Oxy. 654	interpretation promise / collection frame
2	in clean text	P.Oxy. 654	search/find core with marked expansion
3	in clean text	P.Oxy. 654	kingdom within/outside + self-knowledge unit
4	in clean text	P.Oxy. 654	first-last core with child/life frame
5	in clean text	P.Oxy. 654	hidden/revealed maxim with recognition frame
6	in clean text	P.Oxy. 654, lacunose	ethical core only
9	in clean text	Greek retroversion	non-allegorical sower core
10	in clean text	Greek retroversion	fire-casting core
16	in clean text	Greek retroversion	division/household core
20	in clean text	Greek retroversion	mustard-seed parable core
22	in clean text	Greek retroversion	children/kingdom core
25	in clean text	Greek retroversion	love-brother core
26	in clean text	P.Oxy. 1 partial	speck/beam core
31	in clean text	P.Oxy. 1	prophet homeland + physician clause
32	in clean text	P.Oxy. 1	city on high mountain
33	in clean text	P.Oxy. 1 opening only	ear/rooftops + lamp/lampstand unit
34	in clean text	Greek retroversion	blind leading blind
35	in clean text	Greek retroversion	strong man house
36	in clean text	P.Oxy. 655; P.Oxy. 5575 control	anxiety about clothing core
39	in clean text	P.Oxy. 655	keys of knowledge + serpents/doves composite
41	in clean text	no P.Oxy. witness	has/given formula
45	in clean text	Greek retroversion	45A grapes/thorns only
46	in clean text	Greek retroversion, hypothetical; no loaded P.Oxy. witness	46A short John/least-in-kingdom core; full logion appendix-only
47	in clean text	Greek retroversion	47B two masters only
54	in clean text	no P.Oxy. witness	blessed poor
63	in clean text	Greek retroversion	rich-fool core
72	in clean text	no P.Oxy. witness	inheritance-dispute refusal
73	in clean text	no P.Oxy. witness	harvest/workers saying
86	in clean text	Greek retroversion	foxes/birds/Son of Man homelessness core
89	in clean text	Greek retroversion	cup inside/outside core
91	in clean text	Greek retroversion	91A recognition-of-time core; full logion appendix-only
95	in clean text	Greek retroversion	money/non-repayment core
96	in clean text	Greek retroversion	leaven core only
99	in clean text	Greek retroversion	true-family core only
100	in clean text	Greek retroversion	Caesar/God tribute core only
103	in clean text	Greek retroversion	thief/watchfulness core only; full logion appendix-only
107	in clean text	Greek retroversion	lost-sheep core only

Non-Included Logia

These logia remain available in the appendix. The compact index below gives the lookup number, the present publication decision, and the main subject; Greek witness information is separated into the witness index.

Logion	Status	Subject
7	appendix only	full logion
8	appendix only	full logion
11	appendix only	full logion
12	deferred	full logion
13	deferred	full logion
14	deferred	full logion
15	deferred	full logion
17	appendix only	full logion
18	appendix only	full logion
19	deferred	full logion
21	deferred	full logion
23	deferred	full logion
24	deferred	full logion
27	appendix only	full logion
28	appendix only	full logion
29	deferred	full logion
30	deferred	full logion
37	appendix only	full logion
38	appendix only	full logion
40	appendix only	full logion
42	appendix only	full logion
43	deferred	full logion
44	appendix only	full logion
48	deferred	full logion
49	deferred	full logion
50	deferred	full logion
51	deferred	full logion
52	deferred	full logion
53	deferred	full logion
55	appendix only	full logion
56	deferred	full logion
57	appendix only	full logion
58	appendix only	full logion
59	deferred	full logion
60	deferred	full logion
61	deferred	full logion
62	deferred	full logion
64	appendix only	full logion
65	appendix only	full logion
66	appendix only	full logion
67	appendix only	full logion
68	appendix only	full logion
69	appendix only	full logion
70	deferred	full logion
71	deferred	full logion
74	deferred	full logion
75	deferred	full logion
76	appendix only	full logion
77	deferred	full logion
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80	deferred	full logion
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82	appendix only	full logion
83	deferred	full logion
84	deferred	full logion
85	deferred	full logion
87	deferred	full logion
88	deferred	full logion
90	appendix only	full logion
92	deferred	full logion
93	appendix only	full logion
94	appendix only	full logion
97	appendix only	full logion
98	deferred	full logion
101	appendix only	full logion
102	deferred	full logion

Logion	Status	Subject
104	appendix only	bridegroom-fasting core
105	deferred	full logion
106	deferred	full logion
108	deferred	full logion
109	appendix only	full logion
110	deferred	full logion
111	deferred	full logion
112	deferred	full logion
113	appendix only	full logion
114	excluded as secondary	full logion

Witness Index

Witness / Greek Layer	Logia
Greek retroversion	9-11, 14, 16, 20, 22, 25, 34, 35, 45, 47, 63, 86, 89-96, 99-101, 103, 104, 106, 107, 109, 111, 113
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Status Index

Status	Logia
appendix only	7, 8, 11, 17, 18, 27, 28, 37, 38, 40, 42, 44, 55, 57, 58, 64-69, 76, 78, 79, 82, 90, 93, 94, 97, 101, 104, 109, 113
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Bibliography And Rights

Print Source Keys

Bibliography layer status: release verification pass v0.2, updated 2026-07-18; release verification pass v0.2, updated 2026-07-18.

NHC II,2. The Coptic Gospel of Thomas in Nag Hammadi Codex II, tractate 2. Base preserved Coptic witness; final precise readings still require facsimile or critical-edition checking.

P.Oxy. 1; P.Oxy. 654; P.Oxy. 655. Greek Oxyrhynchus papyri used through the open DCLP / Papyri.info XML layer with attribution to the Digital Corpus of Literary Papyri.

SBLGNT. Society of Biblical Literature Greek New Testament, used only as open Greek canonical control, not as a Thomas witness.

Mattison Thomas. Mark M. Mattison's public-domain English Gospel of Thomas translation; used as open translation control, not as EUAGELIA's base text.

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P.Oxy. 5575. Fish, Wallace, and Holmes, "5575. Sayings of Jesus," in The Oxyrhynchus Papyri 87. Protected control material; not used as reproduced base text.

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